MIL-F-40048C
30 September 1984
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-0040048B
3 June 1977
Used IN LIEU OF
MIL-F-40048A
28 March 1962

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FLAGSTAFFS AND INSIGNIA, FLAGSTAFF HEADS GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. - This specification covers wood and metal flagstaffs, and flagstaff heads.

1.2 Classification. - Flagstaffs and flagstaff heads shall be of the following types, components, sizes, classes and style as specified. (see 6.2 and 6.3.)

Type I - Presidential Flagstaff

Size 1 - 10 ft. 3 inch
Size 2 - 8 ft.

Component A - Staff with upper and lower ferrule and male and female coupling mounted.
Component B - Flagstaff head, eagle

Type III - 9 ft. 6 inch jointed flagstaff (colors)

Component A - Staff with lower ferrule and coupling mounted

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22304-5050, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8345

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Component B - Flagstaff head spear.

Type IV - 8 ft. jointed Flagstaff (Guidons)

Component A - Staff with lower ferrule and coupling mounted.
Component B - Flagstaff head spear

Type V - Markers and Marking pennant flagstaff.

Type VI - Navy Battalion flagstaff.

Component A - Staff with base and male and female ferrules mounted
Component B - Flagstaff head, Battleaxe.

Type VIII - Navy Boat Flagstaff.

Component A - Staff with truck (adapter) mounted.
Size - 4 ft. 6 inch
Size - 5 ft.
Size - 5 ft. 6 inch
Size - 6 ft.
Size - 6 ft. 6 inch
Size - 7 ft.
Size - 7 ft. 6 inch
Size - 8 ft.
Size - 8 ft. 6 inch
Size - 9 ft.
Size - 9 ft. 6 inch
Size - 10 ft.

Component B - Flagstaff head, Navy
Style 1 - Spread eagle
Style 2 - Halberd
Style 3 - Ball
Style 4 - Star

Type IX - Automobile flagstaff
Size 1 - President's
Size 2 - Official's

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Type X - Wooden minesweeping flagstaff

Size 1 - Type S.G. and "O" type, Size 5 Floats
Size 2 - Position Buoy
Size 3 - Type 3 Dan Buoy

Type XI - Metal Minesweeping flagstaff

Class 1 - Carbon steel for Size 1 and 4 "O" type floats
Class 2 - Corrosion-Resisting steel, nonmagnetic, for size 0, 1 and 4 "O" Type floats

Type XII - Flagstaff Band

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on data of invitation for bids form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-B-626 - Brass, Leaded and Nonleaded; Rod, Shape, Forgings and Flat Products with Finished Edges (Bars, and Strips.)
QQ-C-320 - Chromium Plating (Electrodeposited.)
QQ-C-390 - Copper Alloy Castings, (Including Cast Bar.)
QQ-P-416 - Plating, Cadmium (Electrodeposited.)
TT-E-489 - Enamel; Alkyd Gloss (for Exterior and Interior Surfaces.)
TT-L-32 - Lacquer, Cellulose Nitrate, Gloss for Aircraft use.
TT-P-59 - Paint; Ready-Mixed, International Orange.
TT-P-636 - Primer Coating, Alkyd, Wood and Ferrous Metal.
TT-V-119 - Varnish, Spar, Phenolic-Resin.
UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Wrapping.
MMM-A-100 - Adhesive, Animal-Glue.
MMM-A-125 - Adhesive, Casein-Type, Water-And Mold-Resistant.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Box, Set-Up.
PPP-P-291 - Paperboard, Wrapping, Cushioning.
PPP-T-45 - Tape, Gummed Paper, Reinforced and Plain, for Sealing and Securing.

MILITARY

MIL-A-22397 - Adhesive, Phenol and Resorcinol Resin Base (For Marine Services.)
MIL-I-17214 - Indicator, Permeability, Low-mu (Go-no-go).

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STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 - Metals, Test Methods
FED-STD-595 - Colors

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-1363 - Measurement of Wood Moisture Content.

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

B-7-1 Flagstaff Head Eagle
B-7-2 Flagstaff Head Spread Eagle
B-7-3 Flagstaff Head Halberd (Navy)
B-7-4 Flagstaff Head Ball (Navy)
B-7-5 Flagstaff Head Spear, Army, Male section
B-7-6 Ferrule, Flagstaff, Army and Flagstaff Head, Spear Female section
B-7-7 Flagstaff Head, Star (Navy)
B-7-8 Flagstaff Head Battleaxe (Navy)
B-7-9 Truck Flagstaff Head (Navy)
B-7-10 Flagstaffs, Army, Details and Assembled views
B-7-11 Flagstaff, Automobile, Metal, Assembly and Details
B-7-12 Flagstaff, Battalion, Navy, Assembly and Details
B-7-13 Flagstaff, Minesweeping, Wooden
B-7-14 Flagstaff, Metal, Floats
B-7-15 Flagstaff Boat (Navy)
B-7-17 Flagstaff Head, Acorn (Wooden)
B-7-19 Flagstaff, Presidential, Details and Assembled Views
B-7-20 Ferrules, Upper and Lower, Presidential Flagstaff
B-7-21 Couplings, Male and Female, Presidential Flagstaff
B-7-26 Flagstaff, Band

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. - In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard sample. - Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a standard sample and/or production plate shall be furnished. When a production plate is furnished, the standard sample shall be used for color and finish only. When no production plate is furnished, the standard samples shall be used as a model in addition to establishing the color and finish.

3.2 First article. - Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample of the finished item covered by this specification shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection and tests as specified in 4.2. The approval of the first article does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The first article shall be manufactured by the contractor in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.3 Material. - Materials shall conform to the referenced specification and the requirements specified herein.

3.3.1 Brass. -

3.3.1.1 Castings. - Brass for castings shall conform to the chemical composition of alloys Nos. A3 or A4 of QQ-C-390 for brass finished end items and Alloys A3, B2 or B5 of QQ-C-390 for Chrome or Gold plated end items.

3.3.1.2 Forgings. - Brass for forgings shall conform to Alloy 377 of QQ-B-626.

3.3.1.3 Machined parts. - The brass used for machine parts shall conform to chemical Alloy 360 of specification QQ-B-626.

3.3.2 Wood. - At the time of milling, all wood for the flagstaffs and acorns shall have been aged a minimum of six months (or the kiln-dried equivalent) and shall have a moisture content of 8 to 12 percent when tested in accordance with 4.4.1. The wood shall be free from checks, splits, crook, and torn or raised grain or any other defect which may affect appearance and serviceability. One tight knot, not to exceed 1/2 inch at largest dimension and not more than one per staff will be permitted. The species of wood for the various types of flagstaffs shall be as follows:

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a. Type I, Birch, Maple, Beech, Ash, Cherry.
b. Type III, IV, V, VI, VIII and Type X, Sizes 1 and 2, Oak, Birch, Beech, Hickory, Ash, Pecan, Cherry or Maple.
c. Type X, size 3, Red spruce or Sitka Spruce.

3.3.3 Gold. - Gold for plating shall be 24 karat.

3.3.4 Primer. - Primer shall conform to TT-P-636.

3.3.5 Enamel. - Enamel shall conform to class A or B of TT-E-489. The color shall be black and shall match color number 17038 of FED-STD-595, except that the following characteristics shall not apply: Unsaponifiable matter, water percent, coarse particles and skins, viscosity, drying time, storage stability, dilution stability, bruising properties and odor.

3.3.6 Glue. -

3.3.6.1 Nonwaterproof glue. - Glue for nonwaterproof service shall conform to one of the following at the option of the manufacturer.

a. Type I or II of MMM-A-100, except that the following characteristics shall not apply: Viscosity, foam, odor, and keeping quality.
b. Type I or II of MMM-A-125, except that the following characteristics shall not apply: Working lye, setting properties.

3.3.6.2 Waterproof glue. - Glue for marine service shall conform to grade A or B of MIL-A-22397, except that the following characteristics shall not apply: Liquid working life, cleanability, adhesive spread, or storage life.

3.3.7 Varnish. -

3.3.7.1 Shore service varnish. - Varnish for on-shore service shall conform to TT-V-121, except that the following characteristics shall not apply: Set to touch, dry hard, free from tack, viscosity, flash point, skinning, and odor.

3.3.8 Steel. - The steel for the bumper clamp clank bolts and bumper bolt shall be any CRQQ or HRCQ steel suitable for the purpose.

3.3.9 Steel Tubing. -

3.3.9.1 Steel tubing, carbon. - Carbon steel tubing shall be welded or seamless, killed or semikilled, commercial grade steel suitable for this purpose.

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3.3.9.2 Steel tubing, corrosion-resistant. - Corrosion-resistant steel tubing shall be type 304, No. 2B finish, commercial grade.

3.3.10 Orange paint. - Orange paint for marine services shall conform to TT-P-59.

3.3.11 Lacquer. - Lacquer shall be clear and shall conform to TT-L-32.

3.3.12 Sterling silver. - The sterling silver shall be not less than 92.5 percent pure silver.

3.4 Construction. - Flagstaff, flagstaff heads, trucks, ferrules, and couplings shall be constructed in accordance with the applicable drawings and the requirements specified herein. Unless otherwise specified herein, staffs shall be made from the types of hardwood specified in 3.3.2. The wood portions shall be turned and sanded smooth. After fabrication, there shall be no warp, bow or croole exceeding 1/32 inch per foot. When screw holes are required for mounting couplings, ferrules, trucks or flagstaff heads, the holes shall be drilled to the proper size and screws shall not be driven by hammer. All threaded components shall be free of damage and foreign material and shall be capable of secure assembly to mating components without difficulty.

Jointed flagstaffs, after assembly, shall be straight throughout, end to end. All metal fittings and wood tenons of the flagstaffs shall be milled, turned, etc. to the specified dimensions so that all flagstaff component parts can be joined to produce a smoothly finished connection without misalignment or gaps exceeding 1/32". Metal couplings of the jointed flagstaffs shall be a force fit, as well, to eliminate looseness within the couplings when the flagstaff is shaken after assembly.

Metal forgings and castings shall have smooth surfaces and shall be free of any gouge, scratch, scuff, machine mark, pit, crack, porosity or other impairment. All edges shall be smooth and free of burrs and slivers.

3.4.1 Type I. -

3.4.1.1 Component A. - Staffs shall be constructed in accordance with drawings B-7-19, B-7-20, and B-7-21. The upper and lower ferrules, coupling and mounting screws shall be made from brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall have a polished gold plated finish. The wood portion of the staff shall be coated with primers specified in 3.3.4 and given 2 coats of enamel specified in 3.3.5. In addition, after enameling the wood portions of the staff it shall have a hand rubbed enamel finish (see 3.5.4).

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3.4.1.2 Component B. - The flagstaff head shall be cast from brass specified in 3.3.1. The design of the eagle shall be controlled by the Government furnished production plate. The eagle shall be cast in two pieces. The legs shall be forced fit into the body and the pieces shall be joined by means of a screw passing through the tail feather and into the ball. The brass eagle shall have a polished gold plated finish. When the eagle is procured as a separate item, the stud shall be furnished with the eagle.

3.4.2 Types III & IV. -

3.4.2.1 Component A. - Staff shall be constructed in accordance with Drawings, B-7-6 and B-7-10. The ferrule and coupling shall be fabricated from brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall have a mirror-like polished chrome plated finish. Screws used for mounting shall be brass nickel plated. Prior to assembly, the staff shall be given 2 coats of varnish in accordance with 3.5.3.

3.4.2.1.1 Assembly. - Metal components (coupling and upper and butt ferrules) shall be assembled to the wooden sections of the staff in accordance with Drawing B-7-10 and the requirements specified herein. Brass spacers shall be placed in a 1/4 inch diameter hole drilled through the tenon in the location specified on the applicable drawing. Locktite Adhesive 324 and Locktite Activator 707 or equal shall be applied to the flagstaff tenon (milled end) and the inside of the metal components respectively. The metal components shall be mounted with the countersunk hole in the side walls in line with the brass spacer in the staff. The brass screw threads shall then be coated with a one step Locktite Adhesive or equal and tightened into the brass spacer.

3.4.2.2 Component B. - The spearhead shall be constructed from brass specified in 3.3.1 in accordance with Drawings B-7-5 and B-7-6 and shall have a mirror-like polished chrome plated finish. When the spearhead is procured separately, mounting screw specified in 3.4.2.1 shall be furnished with the spearhead.

3.4.3 Type V. - The staff shall be constructed in accordance with Drawings B-7-10 and B-7-17. The ferrule and coupling shall be fabricated from brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall have a mirror-like polished chrome plated finish. The acorn shall be fabricated from wood specified in 3.3.2. The acorn shall be free from defects and tumbled or sanded smooth. The acorn shall be secured to the staff by means of glue specified in 3.3.6.1. The glue shall be applied in accordance with manufacturers recommendations. Prior to mounting of the ferrule and coupling; the staff shall be varnished in accordance with 3.5.3. Mounting screws shall be made from brass and shall be nickel plated.

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3.4.4 Type VI. -

3.4.4.1 Component A. - Staffs shall be constructed in accordance with Drawing B-7-12(without battleaxe). The base and couplings shall be fabricated from brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall have a mirror-like polished and lacquered finish. Prior to mounting of the base and couplings, the wood portion of the staff shall be varnished in accordance with 3.5.3. Mounting screws and spacers shall be fabricated from commercial brass and shall be finished to match the couplings.

3.4.4.1.1 Assembly. - Metal components shall be assembled to the wooden sections of the staff in accordance with Drawing B-7-12 and the requirements specified herein. The brass spacer shall be placed in a 1/4 inch diameter hole drilled through the tenon in the location specified on the drawing. Locktite Adhesive 324 and Locktite Activator 707, or equal, shall be applied to the flagstaff tenon (milled end) and the inside of the metal components respectively. The metal components shall be mounted with the countersunk holes in the side walls in line with the brass spacer in the staff. The brass screw shall then be coated with a one-step Locktite Adhesive, or equal, and tightened into the brass spacer.

3.4.4.2 Component B. - Flagstaff head (Battleaxe) shall be constructed from brass specified in 3.3.1 in accordance with Drawing B-7-8 and shall have a mirror-like polished and lacquered finish. When the flagstaff head is ordered as a separate item, two #7 oval head 3/8 inch long mounting screws shall be furnished with the flagstaff head.

3.4.5 Type VIII. -

3.4.5.1 Component A. - Staff shall be constructed in accordance with Drawing B-7-9 and B-7-15. The size required shall be as specified (see 6.2). The truck adapter shall be fabricated from brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall have a polished lacquered finish. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the bottom of the staff shall be flat. Prior to mounting the truck adapter , the wood portions of the flagstaff shall be varnished in accordance with 3.5.3.

3.4.5.1.1 Assembly. - The Truck (adapter) shall be as shown on Drawing B-7-15 and the requirements specified herein. The brass spacers shall be placed in a 1/4 inch diameter hole drelled through the tenon in the location specified on the drawing. Lacktite Adhesive 324 and Locktite Activator 707 or equal, shall be applied to the flagstaff tenon (milled end) and the inside of the metal components respectively. The metal components shall be mounted with the countersunk holes in the side walls in line with the brass spaces in the staff. The brass screw shall then be coated with one step Locktite Adhesive or equal and tightened into the brass spacer.

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3.4.5.2 Component B. - Flagstaff heads shall be fabricated from brass specified in 3.3.1 and shall have a polished lacquered finish. The style flagstaff head desired shall be as specified (see 6.2). When a flagstaff head is procured as a separate item, three oval Phillips head machine screws shall be furnished with the flagstaff head. As an alternate the oval slotted machine screw may be furnished. The screw shall be 1/2 inch long and shall have a No. 10-24 NC 2A thread.

3.4.5.2.1 Style 1. - The spread eagle shall be fabricated in accordance with Drawing B-7-2. When the eagle is cast in two pieces, the pieces shall be jointed by brazing or hard soldering. The whole surface of contact shall be affected.

3.4.5.2.2 Style 2. - The flagstaff head (halberd) shall be fabricated in accordance with Drawing B-7-3.

3.4.5.2.3 Style 3. - The flagstaff head (Ball) shall be fabricated in accordance with Drawing B-7-4.

3.4.5.2.4 Style 4. - The flagstaff head (Star) shall be fabricated in accordance with Drawing B-7-7.

3.4.6 Type IX. - Automobile flagstaff shall be fabricated in accordance with Drawing B-7-11. All metal components shall have corners rounded and all burrs removed. The staff and acorn shall be fabricated from brass in 3.3.1 and shall have a bright chrome plated finish. The bumper clamp, clamp bolt, nut and bumper bolt shall be made from steel specified in 3.3.8 and shall have a cadmium plated finish. The lock washer and screws shall be commercial grade cadmium plated.

3.4.7 Type X flagstaff. - The Type X flagstaffs shall be fabricated in accordance with Drawing B-7-13.

3.4.7.1 Size 1 and 2 staffs. - The size 1 and size 2 staffs shall be given 3 coats of varnish specified in 3.3.7.2 and applied as specified in 3.5.3. Before application of succeeding coats of varnish, the prior coat shall be throughly dried and lightly sanded.

3.4.7.2 Size 3 staff. - The size 3 staff shall be fabricated by gluing six equilateral triangle shape stripe of hardwood together with glue specified in 3.3.6.2. The glue shall be applied as recommended by the manufacturer. After lamination process is completed, the staff shall be machined smooth and given two coats of paint specified in 3.3.10. Prior to application of the second coat, the first coat shall be throughly dried and lightly sanded. When tested as specified in 4.4.5, the staff shall not break.

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3.4.8 Type XI flagstaffs. -

3.4.8.1 Class 1. - The Type XI, class 1, flagstaffs shall be fabricated from carbon steel specified in 3.3.9 in accordance with Drawing B-7-14. The staff shall be free from burrs and sharp edges. The staff shall have both the inside and outside surfaces coated with a commercial zinc chromate primer and two coats of commercial quick drying white alkyd type outside paint shall then be applied to the outside surfaces. Each coat shall be thoroughly dried before the succeeding coat is applied.

3.4.8.2 Class 2. - The Type XI, class 2 flagstaffs shall be fabricated from corrosion-resisting steel specified in 3.3.9.2 except the steel tubing may be welded or seamless in accordance with Drawing B-7-14. When tested as specified in 4.4.7, the magnetic permeability level after fabrication shall not exceed 2.0. The staff shall have the letters "NM" stenciled in orange colored paint specified in 3.3.10. The letters shall be 1/2 inch high and shall be centered between the two 1/4 inch diameter holes located at the top of the staff.

3.4.9 Flagstaff band. - Flagstaff band shall be fabricated from sterling silver specified in 3.3.12 and shall be in accordance with Drawing B-7-26. The faceside of the band (surface to be engraved) shall have a mirror-like polished finish. The reverse face shall be bright. After finishing the complete band shall be coated with lacquer specified in 3.3.11. After lacquering, the face side shall be completely covered with a piece of adhesive paper or tape to protect the finish for engraving. Each band shall be furnished with two cadmium plated oval head wood screws. The screws shall be 1/4 inch long and 3/32 inch in diameter.

3.5 Finishing. - Metal component shall have smooth edges, shall be machined to the specified configuration and shall be furnished in accordance with the applicable requirement specified herein. Plating shall be continous, smooth and adherent without pits, modules, stain or indication of burning. All unplated metal components, as well as those having a plated finish, shall be mirror-like polished. All brass components which are not plated shall be coated with lacquer in accordance with 3.5.2.

3.5.1 Plating. - Prior to plating, the surface to be plated shall be cleaned of all matter which would affect the plating.

3.5.1.1 Gold plating. - Gold plating shall be accomplished using gold specified in 3.3.3. The use of white metal as an underplating shall not be permitted. When tested as specified in 4.4.2., no visible chemical reaction such as evolution of gases shall appear. Gold plated items may be lacquered at the option of the manufacturer.

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3.5.1.2 Cadmium plating. - When cadmium plating is required, the plating shall be in accordance with class 1, Type 1 of QQ-P-416.

3.5.1.3 Chromium plating. - When required, chromium plating shall be in accordance with class 1, Type 1 of QQ-C-320.

3.5.2 Lacquering. - Lacquering shall be accomplished using lacquer specified in 3.3.11. The dry lacquer film shall be continuous, level, adherent and free from lint, dust or other inclusions. When tested as specified in 4.4.6.1, there shall be no change in appearance of the lacquered surface except for a slight yellowing of the highlights and not more than two spots, each less than 1/16 inch largest dimension. When tested as specified in 4.4.6.2, the tissue paper shall not adhere to the lacquered surface.

3.5.3 Varnishing. - Varnishing shall be accomplished using varnishes specified in 3.3.7. The applied varnish shall be smooth, uniform and adherent, without runs, sags, areas of thin film, blisters, peeling or flaking. The completely varnished flagstaff shall not have any foreign matter embedded, any stain, discoloration or gouge, scratch, scuff or other impairment. The Types III, IV, V, and VI staff shall use shore service varnish specified in 3.3.7.1. The Type VIII and Type X, sizes 1 and 2 flagstaff shall use marine service varnish suitable for the purpose. Unless otherwise specified, two coats of varnish shall be applied. Each coat shall be thoroughly dried and the staff lightly sanded before the succeeding coat is applied. When tested as specified in 4.4.3. The tissue paper shall not stick to the staff. When tested as specified in 4.4.4, no ink shall remain on the staff.

3.5.4 Enameling. - When enameling is required, the enamel shall be as specified in 3.3.5. Prior to enameling, the surface to be enameled shall be coated with primer specified in 3.3.4 and thoroughly dried and lightly sanded. The drying and sanding process shall be repeated for each succeeding enamel coat. After the final coat of enamel is applied, the staff shall be given a hand rubbed finish. Enamel shall be applied so that there are no runs or areas of rough or missing film.

3.6 Workmanship. - Flagstaffs or flagstaff components shall be clean, well-made, and meet the acceptable quality established by this specification. Both portions of all jointed flagstaffs shall match in overall shade and appearance, e.g., light wood portions shall not be joined to portions with dark wood.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Inspection responsibility. - Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own, or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements.

4.2 First article inspection. - Inspection and testing of the first article shall be made on a completely finished flagstaff or component for all provisions applicable to the end product examination and tests.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. - Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3.1 Inspection of components. -

4.3.1.1 Testing of components. - In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and standards, inspection shall be performed on components and materials listed in Table II for test characteristics shown. The inspection level shall be S-1.

TABLE II Component testing. -

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Rqm't paragraph	Test method	Rqm't applicable to: Individual unit	Rqm't applicable to: Lot average	#determinations per sample unit	Results reported as	Sample unit
Wood (100 board feet)	species	3.3.2	Visual	x		1	Pass or fail	1 board
	Moisture Content	3.3.2	4.4.1	x		3	Average of 3 determinations to nearest 0.1%	1 component prior to milling

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TABLE II Component testing. - (Cont'd)

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Rqm't para	Test method	Rqm't applicable to: Individual unit	Rqm't applicable to: Lot average	#determ per sample unit	Results reported as	Sample unit
Steel Tubing Corrosion Resisting steel (100 lbs)	Chemical Composition	3,3,9	Method 111 or 112*		x	2 ea element	To the nearest 0.01% each element	4 oz Composite

*FED-STD-151

4.3.1.2 Certification of compliance. - Components and materials listed herein may be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of compliance for the requirements indicated.

Components	Characteristics	Reqm't Ref.
Gold for plating	Karat	3.3.3
Sterling silver	Material Identification	3.3.12
Zinc chromatic primer	Material Identification	3.4.8.1
White alkyd outside paint	Material Identification	3.4.8.1
Glue application	As recommended by glue manufacturer	3.4
Screws and lock washers, and finish	Material Identification	3.4.1, 3.4.2, 3.4.3, 3.4.4, 3.4.5 and 3.4.6
Solder	Material Identification	3.4.5.2

4.3.2 Inprocess inspection. - Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether the quality of material meets specification requirements for appearance and function and whether operations and wether assemblies are accomplished as specified. Inprocess inspection shall be conducted to see if accomplishment of the following is in accordance with the specification requirements:

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Requirement, operation or assembly	Requirement paragraph
Quality of wood	3.2
Sizes of screw holes	3.4
Driving of screws	3.4
Quality of construction	3.4
Application of primer	3.4.8.1 and 3.5.4
Finishing, lacquering and application of adhesive paper or tape	3.4.9
Insertion of brass spacers in tenon.	3.4.2.1.1 and 3.4.4.1.2
Application of Locktite	3.4.2.1.1 and 3.4.4.1.2
Sanding first or first and second coat of enamel as applicable	3.5.4
Varnishing	3.5.3
Lacquering	3.5.2
Finish	3.5
Painting	3.4.8.1

4.3.2.1 Intermediate examination. - The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with the defects classification below. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.3.2.1.1. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one partially fabricated type I, type X, size 3, and type XI, class 1, flagstaff of each size, after fabrication, but prior to the assembly of hardware and the application of primer or finish coatings.

Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Quality of wood	Not species specified	x	-
	Decay or rot	x	-
	Fracture, split, break or splinter.	x	-
	Shake, check, pitch pocket, torn, raised or loose grain	x	-
	Any loose or unsound knot or hole (except specified hole)	x	-
	Tight knot more than 1/2 inch in largest dimension	x	-
	More than one tight knot 1/2 inch or less in largest dimension, per flagstaff or section or staff	-	x
	Wane, larvae channel or other imperfection	-	x
	Any nonpermissible defect filled in with plastic wood or other filler material	-	x

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Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Construction and workmanship	Type X, size 3 staff not laminated of six equilateral triangular shaped segments	x	-
	Laminated staff contains open glue joint 1/16 inch or more in depth or 3 inches or more in length	x	-
	Laminated staff contains open joint less than 1/16 inch in depth or less than 3 inches in length	-	x
	Any segment pieced, i.e., is not the full length of flagstaff	x	-
	Segments of type X, size 3 staff are not in alignment, e.g., edge protrudes	-	x
	Not sanded smooth where required	x	-
Quality of metal	Crack, tear, split or hole (except specified hole)	x	-
	Pipe, burnt spot or incomplete penetration of weld (in welded tubing)	x	-
	Welded tubing has more than one weld (the longitudinal weld necessary for manufacture)	-	x
	Crushed or bent out of shape	x	-
	Burr, sliver, rough edge or sharp edge	-	x
	Not machined, cast or forged to the specified configuration	-	x

4.3.2.1.1 Inspection levels and AQL's. - The inspection levels and acceptable quality level (AQL) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL Major	Total
For defects applicable to 4.3.2.1	II	1.5	6.5

4.3.3 End item examination. - The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.3.3.1 and 4.3.3.2. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.3.3.3. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one assembled flagstaff, or flagstaff head of each type, class size, or styles, as applicable.

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4.3.3.1 Examination of flagstaffs, flagstaff heads, coupling, trucks, and ferrules for visual characteristics.

Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Finish of wooden components	Not finished or finish is not as specified, e.g., type I flagstaff does not have hand rubbed finish . . .	x	-
	Not close match to specified color . . .	-	x
	Finish is not smooth and uniform, e.g., contains run, sag, drip, drop or area of no film or thin film . . .	-	x
	Finish is not adherent, e.g., is blistered, peeling or flaking	-	x
	Stained or discolored	-	x
	Foreign matter imbedded	-	x
	Gouge, scratch, scuff, chipout, machine mark or other impairment	x	-
	Wet or tacky	-	x
Finish of metal components	Not finished	x	-
	Type of finish is not as specified, e.g., is not gold, cadmium, nickel or chrome plated when specified . . .	x	-
	Plating is cut through or is not continuous	x	-
	Plating is not smooth and finegrained . .	-	x
	Plating is not adherent, e.g., is blistered, flaking or peeling	x	-
	Pit, module, stain or indication of burning	-	x
	Excessive edge build up	-	x
	Finish is not as specified, e.g., is not bright, or mirror-like when specified	x	-
	Not lacquered, when specified	x	-
	Lacquer is not clear and transparent, e.g., is cloudy	-	x
	Lacquer coating is not smooth and continuous, e.g., has break in film, contains lump, run, drop or sag	-	x
	Lacquer coating is not adherent, e.g., is blistered, peeling or flaking . . .	-	x

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Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Minor
	Foreign matter included	-	x
	Tarnished, stained, spotted or discolored	-	x
	Gouge, scratch, scuff, machine mark, pit, crack, or other impairment seriously affecting appearance and serviceability.	x	-
	Gouge, scratch, scuff, machine mark, pit, crack, or other impairment affecting appearance or serviceability, but not seriously	-	x
Quality of wood	Not specified species	x	-
	Decay or rot	x	-
	Fracture, split, break or splinter . .	x	-
	Shake, pitch pocket, check, torn, raised or loose grain	x	-
	Loose or unsound knot, or hole (except specified hole)	x	-
	Tight, sound knot more than 1/2 inch in largest dimension	x	-
	More than one tight, sound knot, 1/2 inch or less in largest dimension, per flagstaff or section of staff . . .	-	x
	Warped more than 1/32 inch per foot of length	x	-
	Wane, larvae channel or other imperfection	-	x
	Any nonpermissible defect filled-in with plastic wood or other filler material	-	x
Quality of metal components	Any characteristic not in accordance with the specified design	-	x
	Eagle is not a close match to the standard or approved sample	x	-
	Not fabricated of the specified material	x	-
	Any component broken, fractured, cracked, or split	x	-
	Any component malformed, bent out of shape, miscast, or is otherwise impaired, e.g., collar or band is out of round	x	-

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Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Minor
	Hole (except specified hole)	x	-
	Tubing (where specified) is crushed or bent out of shape	-	x
	Burr, sliver, rough edge, or sharp edge	-	x
	Evidence of blowhole, porosity or shrinkage defect in casting	x	-
	Edge not square or rounded as required	-	x
Construction and workmanship	Any operation omitted or not properly performed when seriously affecting	-	x
	serviceability or appearance	x	-
	Any operation omitted or not properly performed when affecting appearance or serviceablity but not seriously . .	-	x
	Any component misplaced, loose or not in proper alignment	-	x
	Staff is not tapered when required, or taper is not as specified	-	x
	Type X, Size 3 staff not laminated of six equilateral triangular shaped segments	x	-
	Glue joint (in laminated staff) open 1/16 inch or more in depth, or 3 inches or more in length	x	-
	Laminated staff contains open joint less than 1/16 inch in depth or less than 3 inches in length	-	x
	Any segment pieced, i.e., is not full length of flagstaff	x	-
	Segments of type X, size 3 staff are not in alignment, e.g., edge protrudes	-	x
	Thread on metal component is stripped or damaged	-	x
	Components cannot be connected or joined as specified, or assembly is difficult to accomplish	x	-
	Any component (including screw, bolt, or stud) missing	x	-

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Examine	Defects	Classification Major	Minor
	Joint portions of jointed flagstaffs are not straight throughout, end to end, so that top and bottom end are out of alignment by:		
	more than 1/8 inch	x	-
	less than 1/8 inch	-	x
	Solder or brazing missing (where required)	x	-
	Soldered or brazed joint is not continuous, e.g., parts are not completely joined	-	x
	Metal damaged or deformed in soldering or brazing	-	x
	Flux or excess solder not removed . . .	-	x
	Coupling not forced fit to staff (flagstaff loose within coupling when shaken after assembly)	x	-
Marking (Type XI, class 2 flagstaff)	Not marked, or marking is illegible, incorrect, not specified type, size, color, or is not in specified location	x	-

4.3.3.2 Examination of flagstaff or flagstaff components for defects in dimensions. - Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerances shall be classified as a defect.

4.3.3.3 Inspection level and AQL's. - The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units, shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL Major	Total
For defects applicable to 4.3.3.1			
a) Flagstaff assembled	II	2.5	10.0
b) Staffs only (when procured as a separate item).	II	1.5	6.5
c) Flagstaff heads (when procured as a separate item)	II	1.5	6.5

For defects applicable to 4.3.3.2 S-3 (one class) 2.5

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secure assembly to mating components without difficulty.

4.3.3.4 End item testing. - Testing of completely fabricated flagstaff or flagstaff component shall be performed in accordance with Table III for the characteristics shown therein. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated staff or component, as applicable. The inspection level shall be S-1. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units. Determinations are applicable to the individual unit.

TABLE III - End item testing

Characteristic	Reqm't Para.	Test Method	# Determinations Per Sample Unit	Results Reported as
Acid test for Gold plating	3.5.1.1	4.4.2	3	Pass or fail
Test for chrome plating:	3.5.1.3	QQ-C-320		
Thickness			2	To nearest 0.00000 1 inch
Adhesion			1	Pass or fail
Test for Cadmium plating:	3.5.1.2	QQ-P-416		
Thickness			2	To nearest 0.00000 1 inch
Adhesion			1	Pass or fail
Test for Lacquering	3.5 and 3.5.2			
Liver of sulfur		4.4.6.1	1	Pass or fail
Tackiness test		4.4.6.2	1	Pass or fail
Test for Varnishing	3.5.3	4.4.3		
Tackiness test		4.4.3	1	Pass or fail
Coverage test	3.5.3	4.4.4	1	Pass or fail
Breaking load test	3.4.7.2	4.4.5	1	Pass or fail
Magnetic permeability test	3.4.8.2	4.4.7	1	Pass or fail

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components shall be mounted with the countersunk hole in the side walls of

4.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. - An examination shall be made to determine that applicable packaging, packing and marking requirements are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing. Any component damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, inadequate stapling.
weight or content (exterior and interior)	Bulging or distortion of containers. Number of intermediate packages is more, or less, than required, net weight exceeds requirements.

4.4 Tests. -

4.4.1 Moisture content of wood. - Moisture content of wood shall be determined in accordance with MIL-STD-1363.

4.4.2 Acid test for gold plating. - The test acid shall be applied as follows:
Place a drop of test acid (each drop shall be not less than 1/16 inch in diameter) on three different spots on the gold plated surface allowing the drops to remain for not less than 2 minutes, during which time the surface of the insignia shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.5.1.1. The test acid applied at room temperature shall consist of a solution containing 50 percent by volume of CP nitric acid (specific gravity 1.42) and an equal volume of distilled water. If the test insignia has been lacquered, the lacquer must be removed prior to testing.

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4.4.3 Test for varnish tackiness. - A piece of tissue paper shall be wrapped around the varnished flagstaff and grasped tightly for 60 seconds. The tissue shall then be removed and the staff examined to determine compliance with 3.5.3.

4.4.4 Test for varnish coverage. - Water soluble writing fluid shall be applied to the varnished piece by pen or other means. After allowing the ink to stand for 3 minutes, the staff shall be wiped with a damp cloth and the staff examined to determine compliance with 3.5.3.

4.4.5 Breaking load test. - The staff shall be supported at one end in the fashion of a cantilever beam. A full test load of 40 pounds shall be applied to the staff at the point of support and gradually moved out to a point 106 inches plus or minus 1/4 inches from the forward support point. The staff shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.4.7.2.

4.4.6 Lacquer tests. -

4.4.6.1 Liver of sulfur tests. - Lacquered items shall be immersed in a 2 percent by weight CP liver of sulfur (sulfated potash) water solution, at a temperature of 100 degrees F., plus or minus 10 degrees F., for a period of 3 minutes. The item shall then be removed and rinsed in warm, then cold, then hot water. The item shall be wiped gently with a absorbent cellulose material or whirled to remove residual moisture and shall be air dried at room temperature (60 to 80 degrees F.) for 1 hour. The item shall then be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.5.2.

4.4.6.2 Tackiness test. - At room temperature (60 to 80 degrees F.) press a piece of tissue paper against the lacquered surface for 15 seconds, using any pressure capable of being exerted between thumb and two fingers, after which, the pressure shall be released and the item inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.5.2.

4.4.7 Magnetic permeability test. - Magnetic permeability shall be determined in accordance with MIL -I-17214. The results shall be compared to the requirements of 3.4.8.2.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. - Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. -

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5.1.1.1 Types I, III, and IV. -

5.1.1.1.1 Component A. - All staffs shall be disjointed. Metal parts shall be wrapped with not less than two thicknesses of antitarnish tissue paper and over wrapped with cushioning paperboard conforming to type I, style 1 of PPP-P-291. The paperboard shall be secured with 2 inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III of PPP-T-45. The staff section shall then be completely enclosed in a sheet of 50-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. The wrap shall be secured with gummed paper tape specified above.

5.1.1.1.2 Component B. - Flagstaff heads shall be wrapped with not less than two sheets of antitarnish tissue paper and over wrapped with cushioning paper conforming to type I, style 1 of PPP-P-291. The paperboard shall be secured with tape specified in 5.1.1.1.1.

5.1.1.2 Type V. - Staff shall be disjointed. Metal parts shall be wrapped with no less than two thickness of antitarnish tissue paper and overwrapped with cushioning paperboard as specified in 5.1.1.1.1.

5.1.1.3 Type VI. -

5.1.1.3.1 Component A. - Metal parts and staff shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1.1.

5.1.1.3.2 Component B. - Flagstaff heads shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1.2.

5.1.1.4 Type VIII. -

5.1.1.4.1 Component A. - Metal parts and staff shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1.1.

5.1.1.4.2 Component B. - Flagstaff heads shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1.2.

5.1.1.5 Type IX. - Each staff and acorn shall be completely wrapped in not less than two thickness of antitarnish tissue paper and completely enclosed in a sheet of 50 pound minimum basic weight kraft paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. The wrap shall be secured with 2 inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III of PPP-T-45. The bumper clamp assembly, bumper bolt nuts, bumper bolt and lock washers shall be placed together in an end opening drawstring-type bag made from unbleached cotton sheeting cloth.

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5.1.1.6 Type X and XI. - Flagstaffs shall be completely enclosed in a sheet of 50 pounds minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. The wrap shall be secured with 2 inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III of PPP-T-45.

5.1.1.7 Type XII (Flagstaff band). - Each flagstaff band together with the two mounting screws attached to the reverse face of the band by adhesive paper or tape shall be wrapped in three thicknesses of anti-tarnish tissue paper or placed in a snug fitting polyethylene bag and heat sealed. Prior to heat sealing, excess air shall be expelled. One hundred flagstaff bands shall then be packaged in a snug fitting paperboard box conforming to type IV of PPP-B-676. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

5.1.2 Level C. - Flagstaffs with or without flagstaff head or flagstaff heads shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. - Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. - Flagstaff with flagstaff heads, flagstaff without flagstaff head or flagstaff heads of one type, component, size, style, or class, packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a snug fitting shipping container conforming to class weather resistant, V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. The weight of contents of each container shall not exceed the size and weight limitation of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. - Flagstaff with flagstaff heads, flagstaff without flagstaff heads of one type, component, size, style or class packaged as specified in 5.1.1 shall be packed in a snug fitting shipping container conforming to class Domestic, Grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Flagstaffs shall be packed in container having ends reinforced with 1/4 inch thick plywood extending the entire inside width and depth of end of the container. Alternately liners for class Domestic boxes may be used throughout the container. Flagstaff heads, when packed separately from flagstaff, shall be packed in container with the class domestic liners of PPP-B-636. The weight of the contents of each container shall not exceed the size and weight limitation of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C. - Items packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rates for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules and regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

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5.3 Marking. - In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, unit packages, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129, except unit package marking may be printed on the reverse of the mounting card provided the printing is continuous and legible through the bag.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. - Flagstaffs covered by this specification are intended to be used by various offices and units to display national, organizational, individual, or identification flags used within the Department of Defense.

6.2 Ordering Data. - Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title number and date of this specification.
b. Type, component, size, style, and class required (see 1.2, 3.4.5.1 and 3.4.5.2).
c. When a standard sample will not be furnished (see 3.1).
d. When a first article is not required (see 3.2).
e. When a special type of bottom is required (see 3.4.5.1).
f. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Deletion Data. - Type II flagstaff specified in MIL-F-40048A, dated 28 March 1962, has been deleted.

6.4 Type VIII flagstaff heads. -

Style 1 - Spread eagle is used by officials whose official salute is 19 or more guns.
Style 2 - Halberd is used by flag officer ranks or equal.
Style 3 - Ball is used by Naval Captain rank or equal.
Style 4 - Staff is used by commander rank or equal.
Adapter is used for all other grades.

6.5 Flagstaff band. - The flagstaff bands covered by this specification are used as awards for company size Army units which are entitled to campaign participation credits which are not applicable to the battalion or regiments of which they are attached. The band shall be mounted on the flagstaff in accordance with AR 840-10 and AR 672-5-1.

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Project No. 8345 - 0076

Preparing Activity:
The Institute of Heraldry,
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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-F-40048C	For Flagstaffs and Insignia, Flagstaff Heads General Specification

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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